

Before the discussion

Q2 English: background, discussion examples and optional support for the Empire / Echoes learning enquiry.

This handout includes the complete background, station discussion notes and optional support for the final comment. Examples illustrate possible reasoning. Students may develop a different view and revise their work throughout.

Before you begin

This Q2 English activity asks how imperial history helps explain plural British identities today. Each of six cases now pairs history with a documented recent act of remembrance, personal account or official statement. Students practise explaining and limiting those connections before comparing two in an audience-aware final comment. The added challenge lies in inference and judgement, not factual recall. Territorial extent is a starting point, not a measure of human experience.

There is no single British state of mind. Distinguish a state's institutions and official statements from a population's varied identities, and distinguish both from individual experiences. Students may agree, disagree or qualify the final claim. Discuss the evidence and the connections they make, without seeking political agreement.

The route samples South Asia, the Caribbean and Kenya, with comparisons to Canada and Hong Kong. It cannot represent every colony or community. The wider atlas and territory pages provide a route into further enquiries rather than a claim to completeness.

Teacher reference · The sample responses illustrate possible reasoning and invite discussion; students can develop a different view and revise their work throughout.

What students are working towards

- Compare evidence and defend an interpretation or judgement; distinguish an original excerpt from an institutional account or editorial summary, and explain how timing and perspective limit a claim.
- Analyse how a short quotation presents authority or responsibility: connect language choice, purpose, audience and a plausible effect rather than naming a device alone.
- Explain historical connections clearly in English, including colonised people's agency and differences between legal status, lived belonging and public memory.
- Write a coherent school-magazine comment that explains two documented connections, compares their explanatory reach and lets an evidenced complication or source limit shape the overall judgement about British identities.
- Revise one aspect of evidence, organisation or language; use precise vocabulary and connectors to make relationships and limits intelligible.

Set up the lesson

- Before class, open the six stations and final task on the school network. All required evidence, including original excerpts, is readable inside the assignments; external links provide optional provenance and further reading. The application itself must be loaded from the server and is not an offline web cache.
- For limited connectivity, save or print the prepared source cards in advance. Students can use the supplied paraphrases for contextual claims and the printed original excerpts for language analysis. They do not need to navigate a book scan or open a blocked site to finish any case. Keep author, date and source limit with each reading.
- Reserve about 40 minutes for the six station responses and 20 for the final comment, including planning, revision and download. Allow orientation and discussion in addition, or continue across lessons. The most important output is the final explanatory judgement.
- The task names the purpose and audience of each response. Let students use the space they need to explain their idea. Read the supplied evidence, choose a useful detail and discuss its significance; open-ended research is optional extension work.
- Demonstrate changing the year, opening a territory page, and returning to the rallye. Explain that annual map snapshots and present-day geographic units cannot resolve every historical boundary, exact transfer date, local institution or degree of control.
- Ask each student to use their own browser profile and download their learning record when useful. Browser drafts can be lost when browsing data is cleared. On shared computers, download first and use the enquiry's confirmed reset before another student begins.
- Give a brief content note for enslavement, racial discrimination, colonial violence and partition. Require evidence-based language and never ask students to speak on behalf of a nationality, religion or ancestry. No student needs to disclose family history to complete the task.
- Read the background sections and station discussion notes first. The essential reading list is enough to teach this lesson; the extension reading is for answering further questions, not homework required to finish the rallye.

Place in the Q2 English unit

Primary planning materials: Q2_Englisch_UK_5_Verlaufsplanungen_AUSFUEHRLICH_2026_27.pdf (213 pages), Lehrerhandbuch_Q2_Englisch_UK_2026_27.pdf (129 pages), and UK_Q2_Lehrwerksrecherche_SH_2026_27.pdf (22 pages). The shorter 28-page plans and the three supplied classroom documents are supplementary. These documents guide the teaching sequence and its learning aims.

The guide follows the handbook's principle that selected historical knowledge should serve analysis of the present, with careful distinctions between evidence, interpretation and judgement (handbook, PDF pp. 12-13). Its primary competence focus is reading and text/media analysis leading to written production; the follow-up provides a brief speaking opportunity.

Possible placement: consolidate historical anchors before Plan A's memory discussion (detailed plans, PDF pp. 41-43), or connect a contemporary belonging enquiry to Plan B's functional use of background knowledge (PDF pp. 75, 79). This is an adaptation using this app's sources and products, not a reproduction of those lessons.

The route covers one Empire-to-postcolonial-Britain enquiry. It does not replace the full UK unit, the Elizabethan Age strand, or planned listening, viewing, mediation and extended speaking lessons. The primary plans assign distinct competences to those lessons; changing the medium changes the learning opportunity.

Plan the lesson

- Before the enquiry: briefly demonstrate the evidence cards, map return, optional notes and downloads. Distinguish original wording from a labelled paraphrase. Ask students to explain a connection rather than simply place an old fact beside a modern one; do not pre-teach the examples.
- Allow about 40 minutes for the six stations: 6, 7, 7, 7, 6 and 7 minutes. Each response practises a historical-to-modern connection through a different task: judgement, editorial choice, language comparison, family memory, causal explanation or evaluation of recognition. The map and extra sources are optional explorations.
- Protect about 20 minutes for the final comment: for example, 4 to choose two cases and retrieve evidence, 11 to draft, 4 to check the comparison and qualification, and 1 to download. The final page brings each case's saved response, notes and core sources together, so students do not need to start research again.
- Plan orientation and debrief in addition to this 60-minute enquiry. If the timetable is shorter, split the route across lessons and keep the final writing time intact; browser saving and downloads support continuation. These are flexible estimates, not timers or results from a classroom trial.
- In the debrief, partners defend one connection with a named source and explain what it does not establish. Ask the partner to identify how that limit changes the conclusion, then offer one evidence question and one optional language suggestion. Give writers time to revise and carry one researchable question into the next class text.

Transfer to the class materials

- Pathway Advanced 2024: Robert Tombs, *In Defence of the British Empire*, and Afua Hirsch, *The New Black*, offer subsequent comparison of argument and perspective; Paul Hawkins, *The Bloody British!*, supports analysis of irony and stereotypes (material research, PDF p. 7). The app supplies historical evidence for these readings, not their text or conclusions.
- Context 2022: *Taking Stock: The Mood in the UK* is a dated journalistic representation; Sathnam Sanghera, *The Legacy of the Empire*, and the Argumentative Writing skills lab provide a natural transfer from this comment to fuller text analysis (material research, PDF p. 11). Do not treat a newspaper mood account as a survey of all British people.
- Green Line: *The Voyage of the Empire Windrush* is listed as listening, alongside Andrea Levy's *Back to My Own Country* (material research, PDF p. 9). The app's short written evidence can prepare or consolidate that lesson but does not practise understanding its audio.
- Abi-Box: *Changing views of the British Empire*, *British history: Pride or shame?* and the role-play *Decolonising the curriculum?* can extend evidence into a comparison or discussion. The impact of British colonialism and *Empireworld* are listed as listening and should retain that mode (material research, PDF p. 14).
- Material titles and formats above are reported by the supplied research, not verified here from every licensed book or platform. Its own evidence/access limits appear on PDF p. 5. Check the school's edition, page numbers, excerpt length, licence and media access before assigning anything. These class-copy links are optional follow-up; no full copyrighted classroom reading is required or reproduced in the app.

English language and feedback

- Compare and judge: explain what each piece of evidence shows, choose a criterion and defend the judgement. Interpret: connect details to an argument while keeping their dates and scope clear. Analyse: quote briefly and explain how wording works in context. Evaluate and comment: weigh evidence, consider a complication and reach a qualified position for the stated audience.
- Model the chain: “The phrase ... presents ... as For this audience, it may ... because However, it cannot show” An effect is a justified interpretation, not a claim that every reader reacted identically.
- For the school magazine, look for an accessible opening, two connected examples and a clear qualified judgement. Useful language includes “contributed to”, “helps explain”, “in this case”, “although” and “this does not establish”. Avoid deterministic claims about what all British people think.
- Feedback example: “Your Windrush detail supports the link between imperial status and later treatment. Explain that link before the next example. For language, replace ‘everyone’ with a precise group and use ‘although’ to connect legal status and unequal treatment.” Ask the student to make the revision immediately.

The route · about 60 minutes

Allow time for the final written judgement. Students can revisit the atlas and their sources throughout.

6 min **When trade becomes rule**

1757 → 1765 · remembered in 2020-2021 · Commerce, wealth and power

7 min **Who made freedom happen?**

1831 → 1838 · remembered in 2024 · Enslavement, resistance and remembrance

7 min **One colour, unequal power**

1858 → 1949 → 2024 · Authority, agency and unequal citizenship

7 min **Independence is more than a border**

1947 · remembered in 2022 · Decolonisation and its human consequences

6 min **Who gets to belong?**

1948 → the 2020 review → 2022 · Citizenship, migration and everyday belonging

7 min **When does an empire end?**

1950s → 1963 → 2013 → 2023 · Independence, responsibility and continuing connections

20 min **The past inside the present**

1600 → today · A comment for your school magazine

Background for the conversation

Read these notes before the lesson; use the examples and prompts to support the conversation.

Britain, the UK and identities: establish the vocabulary

England is one country within the UK. Great Britain refers geographically to the island containing England, Scotland and Wales; the United Kingdom also includes Northern Ireland. The state changed during the period studied: the 1707 union created Great Britain, and the 1801 union created the United Kingdom of Great Britain and Ireland. Do not project today's borders or citizenship categories backwards.

Britishness is not a single ethnicity, opinion or emotional attachment. English, Scottish, Welsh, Northern Irish, Irish, British and other identities can overlap. The 2021 England and Wales census allowed more than one national identity. Its results describe self-identification in those two countries, not attitudes to empire or the whole UK. A changed order of response options also complicates comparisons with 2011.

A useful classroom distinction is between legal membership, felt belonging and an official national story. These may reinforce one another or conflict. A minister's speech supplies evidence of an official position at a particular time; it does not establish what all citizens believe. Treat any claim that empire caused a modern political choice as a hypothesis needing further evidence.

- UK Parliament · the Union, constitution and trade

<https://www.parliament.uk/about/living-heritage/evolutionofparliament/legislativescrutiny/act-of-union-1707/overview/the-articles-constitution-and-trade/>

- ONS · National identity, England and Wales: Census 2021

<https://www.ons.gov.uk/peoplepopulationandcommunity/culturalidentity/ethnicity/bulletins/nationalidentityenglandandwales/census2021>

Connect evidence across time without assuming continuity

The prepared contemporary examples document specific actions: Shropshire Council's 2020-2021 Clive interpretation; M Shed's 2024 contested-statue display; Charles's 2024 Commonwealth speech; Javed's 2022 London museum display; the 2020/2022 Windrush reviews and 2022 monument; and the 2023 royal account of Kenya. Their dates remain part of the claim. They are evidence relevant to thinking about Britain today, not observations of all views or circumstances in 2026.

In each case, identify what history explains and what later agency adds. Clive's Company role explains the subject of a commemoration dispute, while a council selects its response. Partition supplies Javed's family history, while he chooses to exhibit an object. Imperial subjecthood supplies a relationship, while later policy decisions and record failures produce a specific mechanism of exclusion. Neither an inherited relationship nor a later choice alone supplies every explanation.

The final task compares explanations, not the moral seriousness of different harms. A personal quotation, an institutional statement, a museum intervention and census labels answer different questions. A source's inability to establish a population-wide claim is a reason to narrow or suspend that claim; it is not evidence that the historical influence must be small. Accept different qualified judgements that respect these boundaries.

- Shropshire Council · Robert Clive statue update. 19 November 2021

<https://newsroom.shropshire.gov.uk/2021/11/robert-clive-statue-in-the-square-shrewsbury-an-update/>

- [Bristol Museums · M Shed's Colston statue display, 15 March 2024](https://www.bristolmuseums.org.uk/blog/new-display-at-m-shed-the-toppling-of-the-colston-statue/)
<https://www.bristolmuseums.org.uk/blog/new-display-at-m-shed-the-toppling-of-the-colston-statue/>
- [British Museum · Imran Javed, A Confluence of Stories, 24 October 2022](https://www.britishmuseum.org/blog/confluence-stories)
<https://www.britishmuseum.org/blog/confluence-stories>
- [Wendy Williams · Windrush review progress update, 31 March 2022](https://www.gov.uk/government/publications/windrush-lessons-learned-review-progress-update/windrush-lessons-learned-review-progress-update-accessible)
<https://www.gov.uk/government/publications/windrush-lessons-learned-review-progress-update/windrush-lessons-learned-review-progress-update-accessible>
- [Royal Household · Charles III at the Commonwealth Heads of Government meeting, 25 October 2024](https://www.royal.uk/news-and-activity/2024-10-25/his-majestys-speech-to-open-the-commonwealth-heads-of-government)
<https://www.royal.uk/news-and-activity/2024-10-25/his-majestys-speech-to-open-the-commonwealth-heads-of-government>
- [Royal Household · Charles III at the state banquet in Kenya, 31 October 2023](https://www.royal.uk/news-and-activity/2023-10-31/a-speech-by-his-majesty-the-king-at-the-state-banquet-kenya)
<https://www.royal.uk/news-and-activity/2023-10-31/a-speech-by-his-majesty-the-king-at-the-state-banquet-kenya>

Trade and conquest were intertwined, but empire was not one system

The East India Company began in 1600 as an English trading corporation. Its growth into a territorial power depended on armed force as well as negotiation, alliances and Indian labour. Victories in the mid-eighteenth century and revenue rights in Bengal in 1765 helped link commerce with government. A royal charter did not mean that the Crown directly administered every Company possession.

Follow the mechanism rather than merely listing acquisitions: authority to collect revenue could finance armies and administration, which could enable further expansion. This is an explanatory chain, not proof that all revenue reached Britain, that expansion was inevitable, or that everyone in Britain benefited equally.

A single colour hides constitutional differences. Canada's 1867 confederation established a federal dominion under the Crown; India passed from Company to Crown rule in 1858. Self-government for settler institutions was not the same as equal political power for every inhabitant. Neither label should be confused with immediate, complete independence.

- [National Army Museum · Battle of Plassey](https://www.nam.ac.uk/explore/battle-plassey)
<https://www.nam.ac.uk/explore/battle-plassey>
- [National Army Museum · Clive at Plassey, 1757](https://collection.nam.ac.uk/detail.php?acc=1968-06-269-1)
<https://collection.nam.ac.uk/detail.php?acc=1968-06-269-1>
- [UK Parliament · British North America Act 1867](https://www.parliament.uk/about/living-heritage/evolutionofparliament/legislativescrutiny/parliament-and-empire/collections1/parliament-and-canada/british-north-america-act-1867/)
<https://www.parliament.uk/about/living-heritage/evolutionofparliament/legislativescrutiny/parliament-and-empire/collections1/parliament-and-canada/british-north-america-act-1867/>

Emancipation needs a history of resistance as well as legislation

Keep three dates apart: 1807 prohibited the British slave trade; the 1833 Slavery Abolition Act came into effect in 1834 across most British colonies; in Jamaica, compulsory apprenticeship continued until 1838. The dates mark different legal changes. Abolition did not itself remove racial hierarchy, economic dependency or colonial rule.

Credit enslaved people's resistance and organising alongside abolitionists, religious networks and parliamentary action. A story centred only on Westminster makes freedom look like a gift. The legislation also compensated slave-owners, not the people who had been enslaved. UCL's work follows those compensation records into British families, institutions and economic life.

The interpretive question is how commemoration selects evidence. It is possible to value abolitionist campaigning while recognising the preceding violence and continuing inequality. Students should explain what an account makes visible and what it leaves out, rather than mechanically replacing a story of pride with a story in which every person held the same responsibility.

- UK Parliament · The West Indian colonies and emancipation

<https://www.parliament.uk/about/living-heritage/evolutionofparliament/legislativescrutiny/parliament-and-empire/parliament-and-the-american-colonies-before-1765/the-west-indian-colonies-and-emancipation/>

- UCL · Research on British slave-ownership and its legacies

<https://www.ucl.ac.uk/research-innovation/case-studies/2014/dec/engaging-legacies-british-slave-ownership>

- UCL · Centre for the Study of the Legacies of British Slavery

<https://www.ucl.ac.uk/social-historical-sciences/history/research/research-projects-and-centres/centre-study-legacies-british-slavery-cslbs>

Resistance, decolonisation and the limits of a disappearing colour

The 1857 rebellion had military, political, economic and religious causes. Cartridge controversy was a trigger rather than a sufficient explanation. Participation varied: soldiers, rulers and civilians did not share one programme, and some Indian groups supported the Company. The 1858 transfer to Crown rule shows a major constitutional change; it does not show that resistance ended or that rule became consensual.

In 1947 British withdrawal and partition produced independent India and Pakistan. Anti-colonial mobilisation, political negotiation and Britain's changing capacity all belong in the explanation. Punjab and Bengal were divided, with mass displacement and violence. The new borders were announced after the independence ceremonies. A map can show a political change while concealing upheaval in people's lives.

Do not present partition as an automatic consequence of religious difference or reduce responsibility to a single actor. A strong enquiry asks how decisions, institutions, timing and local violence interacted. British official records illuminate decision-making but should be read alongside testimony and South Asian perspectives; administrative language is not the whole experience.

- National Army Museum · Why did the Indian Rebellion happen?

<https://www.nam.ac.uk/explore/why-did-indian-mutiny-happen>

- The National Archives · Partition of British India

<https://www.nationalarchives.gov.uk/education/teaching-resources/partition-of-british-india/>

- The National Archives · Indian independence, part one

<https://www.nationalarchives.gov.uk/education/teaching-resources/indian-independence-part-one/>

Migration made imperial connections part of life in Britain

The Empire Windrush's 1948 arrival is a landmark, not the beginning of Black presence in Britain or a description of every Caribbean migrant. British subjecthood already linked people in the Caribbean to Britain. The British Nationality Act received assent after the ship's arrival and took effect on 1 January 1949; it created citizenship of the UK and Colonies. Do not say the Act caused that June voyage.

Citizenship and membership of an imperial political community did not guarantee equal treatment in housing, work or public life. Migrants also organised, worked, raised families and shaped culture and institutions. Their histories help explain why British identity can include Caribbean and other inheritances rather than treating them as external additions.

The Windrush scandal gives a documented later connection between past status and state practice. The Williams review examined serious failures affecting people lawfully living in the UK, including failures to understand their history. This is evidence about institutions and policies, not a licence to attribute identical beliefs to every British person. Current legal status cannot be inferred from a historic label alone.

- The National Archives · Ena Clare Sullivan nationality registration, 3 December 1968 (HO 334/1406/110478), PDF pp. 19-21
<https://cdn.nationalarchives.gov.uk/documents/education/empire-windrush-caribbean-migration.pdf#page=19>
- The National Archives · Nationality and the Immigration Act 1971
<https://www.nationalarchives.gov.uk/education/resources/commonwealth-migration-since-1945/changes-to-british-nationality-act-with-immigration-act-1971/>
- Wendy Williams · Windrush Lessons Learned Review (2020)
<https://www.gov.uk/government/publications/windrush-lessons-learned-review>
- Independent research · The Historical Roots of the Windrush Scandal
<https://www.gov.uk/government/publications/the-historical-roots-of-the-windrush-scandal/the-historical-roots-of-the-windrush-scandal-independent-research-report-accessible>

Formal endings did not close every historical question

Kenya became independent in 1963. In June 2013 the UK government acknowledged torture and ill-treatment under colonial administration and expressed regret while announcing a settlement with 5,228 claimants. The £19.9 million sum included costs. The statement maintained the government's denial of legal liability; it was not a settlement of every colonial claim or a general legal finding about the empire.

That statement can support an argument that imperial history still shapes official obligations and public memory. Its wording also reveals the limits of what the government was prepared to acknowledge. Survivors' pursuit of redress is part of the explanation, not a detail to place after the government's action.

Hong Kong's 1997 transfer concerned sovereignty, not the creation of an independent state. The 1984 Joint Declaration is evidence of what the two governments agreed, not a survey of residents' wishes. Use 1997 as a significant endpoint in this atlas, not as proof that every British overseas relationship ended that year.

The Commonwealth's charter describes independent and equal sovereign members. Its ideals are useful evidence of an institutional self-description. They are neither evidence that all members share one identity nor proof that proclaimed equality has always been realised. Historical connections can endure while their political form changes.

- UK Government · Statement on settlement of Mau Mau claims, 6 June 2013
<https://www.gov.uk/government/news/statement-to-parliament-on-settlement-of-mau-mau-claims>
- Sino-British Joint Declaration · treaty text, 1984
<https://www.cmab.gov.hk/en/issues/jd2.htm>
- The Commonwealth · Charter, 2013
<https://thecommonwealth.org/charter>

Common misconceptions

- “England”, “Great Britain” and “the United Kingdom” are interchangeable. Correct by identifying geography, institutions and the time period before making an argument.

- A coloured territory means uniform, uncontested control. Ask which kind of authority the layer represents, whose institutions continued, and what the map cannot show.
- Abolition happened in one year and was simply given by Britain. Separate trade abolition, emancipation, apprenticeship, resistance and continuing inequality.
- Independence means that previous relationships or inequalities disappeared. Separate sovereignty from migration, language, trade, memory and institutions.
- An official apology, regret or settlement proves everyone agrees. Identify the speaker, precise wording, date, audience and limits of the claim.
- Empire explains every modern British attitude. Require a mechanism and evidence; leave room for other histories and disagreement within and between communities.
- A forceful condemnation or celebration supplies its own evidence. Ask which source supports the claim, and leave space for a student to qualify or revise it.

Station discussion notes

These examples open up possible lines of reasoning. Invite students to compare them with their own ideas and explore different conclusions.

1. When trade becomes rule

6 minutes · flexible planning guide

The student scenario

The East India Company began as an English trading business run by merchants who wanted to make money from trade with Asia. In 1600, Queen Elizabeth I gave it a charter: an official document allowing the Company to operate. That permission did not make it the ruler of India. Over time, the Company became involved in wars and agreements with Indian rulers, as well as buying and selling goods.

This stop takes you to Bengal, in the eastern part of the Indian subcontinent. In 1757, the Company helped change its ruler; in 1765, it gained the right to collect taxes, called revenue. The later evidence takes you to a debate about a statue of Robert Clive in Shrewsbury. A statue in a public square gives a selected person a visible place in a town's history. Consider how knowledge of Company rule affects what that act of remembrance might mean.

Student task

How far does Company rule in Bengal help explain the debate over Clive's statue in Shrewsbury? Choose the strongest historical evidence and use the council record to justify your answer. Distinguish what this debate reveals about public memory from what it can tell you about people across Britain.

Connect and judge · Your judgement on a public monument

Map reference: british-india, 1765.

One possible response

Company rule helps explain why honouring Clive is controversial. The 1765 revenue rights show sustained governing power, not simply successful trade; that changes what a monument to him can celebrate. In 2020 Shropshire Council chose to keep the statue while adding historical explanation, and its 2021 update records a temporary panel. The history explains the subject of the dispute, but does not dictate one response: the council chose reinterpretation. This is strong evidence that an institution was reconsidering public honour, but it cannot establish what people across Britain believe about empire.

Notes for the conversation

The task now asks why Company history matters to a documented British public-memory dispute. Students can choose 1757 political intervention or 1765 revenue rights as their strongest evidence, but must explain what it changes about commemorating Clive. Shropshire Council decided to retain the statue with interpretation in 2020; its 2021 update records a temporary panel, not proof that every planned permanent measure was completed. A statue and its interpretation are decisions about public honour. The council record establishes the institution's response to petitions, not the views of all Shrewsbury residents or all Britons. Historical knowledge helps explain the dispute's subject; later petitions and council choices help explain its form. Keep those explanatory steps distinct.

Evidence to draw on

- [National Army Museum · Battle of Plassey](https://www.nam.ac.uk/explore/battle-plassey)
<https://www.nam.ac.uk/explore/battle-plassey>
- [National Army Museum · Clive at Plassey, 1757](https://collection.nam.ac.uk/detail.php?acc=1968-06-269-1)
<https://collection.nam.ac.uk/detail.php?acc=1968-06-269-1>
- [Shropshire Council · Robert Clive statue update, 19 November 2021](https://newsroom.shropshire.gov.uk/2021/11/robert-clive-statue-in-the-square-shrewsbury-an-update/)
<https://newsroom.shropshire.gov.uk/2021/11/robert-clive-statue-in-the-square-shrewsbury-an-update/>
- [Shropshire Council · statement about the Clive statue, 25 September 2020](https://newsroom.shropshire.gov.uk/2020/09/robert-clive-statue-shrewsbury/)
<https://newsroom.shropshire.gov.uk/2020/09/robert-clive-statue-shrewsbury/>

Other possible interpretations

- A student may find the colonial history central to understanding why Clive's public honour became disputed, while arguing that it does not determine whether the statue should be removed or reinterpreted.
- A student may emphasise the council's distinction between explaining history and celebrating it: retaining an object and changing its interpretation can alter the public story without establishing what viewers think.

Misconceptions to discuss

- A charter in 1600 gave the Company ownership of India.
- Company rule and direct Crown government were identical.
- A council decision or petition proves a national consensus about empire.

Use in discussion

- What difference does it make to display a monument in a public square?
- Does knowing the history settle how it should be remembered, or leave room for different choices?

2. Who made freedom happen?

7 minutes · flexible planning guide

The student scenario

Jamaica was a British colony in the Caribbean. On plantations, enslaved people were forced to work, often producing sugar for sale overseas. Enslavement meant that people were treated as property and denied control over their own lives. They resisted in different ways, while campaigners also demanded an end to slavery. Abolition means ending a practice through law; emancipation means being freed from slavery.

Resistance in Jamaica and decisions in Britain's Parliament formed part of the struggle over slavery and freedom. A museum label chooses whose actions readers encounter. You will propose wording for one, then consider a real museum display in Bristol in 2024. The display concerns a statue of Edward Colston, who was involved in the slave trade long before the Jamaican rebellion. These are different histories within the wider question of how Britain remembers slavery.

Student task

Rewrite this proposed museum label: "Britain gave enslaved people their freedom." Use the Jamaica sources to decide whose actions matter. Explain which idea about Britain your changes invite visitors to reconsider, using the historical evidence and one feature of M Shed's 2024 display.

Rewrite and interpret · Your museum label and its purpose

Map reference: jamaica, 1838.

One possible response

Proposed label: Enslaved people in Jamaica resisted slavery. Colonial forces threatened rebels with death; parliamentary abolition later left compulsory apprenticeship in place until 1838, while compensation went to owners. Freedom involved struggle and an incomplete legal transition. My wording invites visitors to reconsider an image of Britain as the sole giver of freedom. M Shed's 2024 display keeps evidence of the Colston statue protest visible and includes differing perspectives. It too makes conflict over public honour visible, though Colston's slave trading belongs to a different history from the Jamaican rebellion. These choices show how public memory can challenge a national story; they do not prove visitors all change their minds.

Notes for the conversation

The proposed label is the classroom writing stimulus, not a quotation from M Shed. Students should use both Jamaica sources to make an editorial choice, then explain its relevance to a real feature of the Bristol museum's 2024 display. Cotton's 1832 proclamation records colonial threats and reveals resistance, but does not provide the rebels' own account. Parliament's account makes apprenticeship and compensation visible. M Shed's preserved graffiti, protest material and contrasting perspectives document contested public memory. Colston's earlier slave trading and the Jamaican rebellion are different episodes; do not merge their actors or dates. A display can invite reconsideration of a national story without proving how visitors respond. Do not require a uniformly celebratory or condemnatory conclusion.

Evidence to draw on

- [The National Archives · Willoughby Cotton's proclamation, 2 January 1832 \(CO 137/181\), PDF pp. 6-7](https://cdn.nationalarchives.gov.uk/documents/education/spotlight-on-baptist-war.pdf#page=6)
<https://cdn.nationalarchives.gov.uk/documents/education/spotlight-on-baptist-war.pdf#page=6>

- [UK Parliament · The West Indian colonies and emancipation](#)

<https://www.parliament.uk/about/living-heritage/evolutionofparliament/legislativescrutiny/parliament-and-empire/parliament-and-the-american-colonies-before-1765/the-west-indian-colonies-and-emancipation/>

- [Bristol Museums · M Shed's Colston statue display, 15 March 2024](#)

<https://www.bristolmuseums.org.uk/blog/new-display-at-m-shed-the-toppling-of-the-colston-statue/>

- [Jamaica Information Service · Samuel Sharpe](#)

<https://jis.gov.jm/information/heroes/samuel-sharpe/>

- [UCL · Research on British slave-ownership and its legacies](#)

<https://www.ucl.ac.uk/research-innovation/case-studies/2014/dec/engaging-legacies-british-slave-ownership>

Other possible interpretations

- A label may foreground resistance while acknowledging parliamentary action; M Shed's inclusion of protest can support a connection to whose actions become visible in public memory.
- A student may emphasise the gap between abolition and full freedom, then use the display's differing perspectives to argue that public memory remains contested. The display does not prove that all visitors adopt the student's view.

Misconceptions to discuss

- The 1807 Act immediately freed enslaved people in Jamaica.
- Those formerly enslaved received the compensation.
- The proposed classroom label is M Shed's own wording, or Colston was an actor in the 1831 Jamaican rebellion.

Use in discussion

- What changes when a museum displays evidence of a protest alongside a monument?
- What can a display show about public debate, and what would you need to know about visitors' responses?

3. One colour, unequal power

7 minutes · flexible planning guide

The student scenario

By the mid-nineteenth century, the East India Company governed large parts of India. In 1857, soldiers and other groups rose against its rule. Their reasons and aims differed; people in India did not all take the same side. After the uprising, Britain's Parliament transferred the Company's governing powers to the Crown in 1858. Crown rule meant government under the authority of the British monarch, carried out through British ministers and officials.

Victoria's proclamation, a public announcement, presented the new government's position after conflict and distrust. Much later, independence changed the relationship: India became independent in 1947, and the 1949 London Declaration allowed it to remain in the Commonwealth as a republic. The monarch symbolised an association of independent countries rather than ruling India. Read Victoria's words alongside Charles III's 2024 account of his Commonwealth role. Compare what these official statements present with what they can establish about people's experiences.

Student task

How has the relationship presented by the monarchy changed from Victoria's proclamation to Charles's 2024 Commonwealth speech? Analyse one phrase from Victoria and use the 1949 change to explain your comparison. Judge what these sources reveal about the monarchy's image of Britain's place in the world, and how much that image can tell us about British identities.

Compare official language · Your reading of Britain's royal image

Map reference: british-india, 1858.

One possible response

Victoria's phrase "equal and impartial" presents the Crown as a fair protector after rebellion, but the relationship remains one of ruler and subjects. India's independence and the 1949 agreement that it could remain a Commonwealth member as a republic changed that relationship. Charles's 2024 account presents independent countries cooperating, with painful shared history to address, rather than the monarch governing India. Empire helps explain why the monarchy needs to describe a changed place in the world. The sources establish this institutional image, not that equality was achieved or that British people all identify with it. Shared language of fairness alone would not prove unchanged power.

Notes for the conversation

Analyse an exact phrase from Victoria's proclamation, then use the intervening constitutional change to interpret Charles's 2024 account. "Equal and impartial" offers protection within a relationship of ruler and subjects; it does not promise independent statehood. India's independence and the 1949 agreement that a republic could remain in the Commonwealth changed the relationship. The monarch is now a symbolic head of an association of independent countries, not India's ruler. Charles's speech supplies a royal self-presentation of cooperation, painful shared history and equality. Similar ideals do not prove unchanged power or a causal inheritance of popular beliefs. The task asks what this institutional image can reveal about ideas of Britain, while reserving judgement about acceptance or practice. The modern card distinguishes its paraphrase from a short original quotation. Interpret Charles's position through the account; analyse only the printed quotation as his exact wording. The Victoria excerpt is reproduced from Appendix E of His Majesty King George's Speeches in India, with provenance linked separately.

Evidence to draw on

- [Tamil Digital Library · His Majesty King George's Speeches in India, Appendix E, PDF p. 178 / printed xviii: reproduction of the 1858 proclamation](https://tamildigitallibrary.in/assets/docs/uploads/primary_files/book/TVA_BOK_0025134/TVA_BOK_0025134_speeches_in_India.pdf#page=178)
https://tamildigitallibrary.in/assets/docs/uploads/primary_files/book/TVA_BOK_0025134/TVA_BOK_0025134_speeches_in_India.pdf#page=178
- [British Library · catalogue record for the proclamation of 1 November 1858](https://searcharchives.bl.uk/catalog/041-000566434)
<https://searcharchives.bl.uk/catalog/041-000566434>
- [The Commonwealth · London Declaration, 1949](https://thecommonwealth.org/london-declaration-1949)
<https://thecommonwealth.org/london-declaration-1949>
- [Royal Household · Charles III at the Commonwealth Heads of Government meeting, 25 October 2024](https://www.royal.uk/news-and-activity/2024-10-25/his-majestys-speech-to-open-the-commonwealth-heads-of-government)
<https://www.royal.uk/news-and-activity/2024-10-25/his-majestys-speech-to-open-the-commonwealth-heads-of-government>
- [National Army Museum · Why did the Indian Rebellion happen?](https://www.nam.ac.uk/explore/why-did-indian-mutiny-happen)
<https://www.nam.ac.uk/explore/why-did-indian-mutiny-happen>

- [UK Parliament · British North America Act 1867](https://www.parliament.uk/about/living-heritage/evolutionofparliament/legislativescrutiny/parliament-and-empire/collections1/parliament-and-canada/british-north-america-act-1867/)

<https://www.parliament.uk/about/living-heritage/evolutionofparliament/legislativescrutiny/parliament-and-empire/collections1/parliament-and-canada/british-north-america-act-1867/>

Other possible interpretations

- A student may emphasise transformation: an imperial ruler's assurance becomes a symbolic leader's account of cooperation between independent members. Imperial history explains why this change and painful shared history matter.
- A student may identify a continuing institutional wish to present authority as fair, while explaining that rhetorical resemblance alone cannot establish continuity in constitutional power, public belief or lived equality.

Misconceptions to discuss

- An official statement proves that its promises were fulfilled.
- The Commonwealth is simply the empire renamed, or the monarch governs all its members.
- A royal speech expresses the identity of every British person.

Use in discussion

- What would be misleading about describing the Commonwealth as the empire with a different name?
- What evidence could test whether a royal statement is accepted by people inside or outside Britain?

4. Independence is more than a border

7 minutes · flexible planning guide

The student scenario

In 1947, British rule in India ended after decades of political campaigning, resistance and negotiations. British India was divided into two independent countries, India and Pakistan. This division is called partition. New borders cut through Punjab and Bengal, regions where people from different religious communities lived. Millions of people fled or were forced to leave their homes, and violence affected many communities around the time of independence.

A map can show new countries and borders; individual accounts reveal concerns and experiences it leaves out. The archive's Singh letter and the experience remembered by Iqbal's aunt both concern events before the 1947 border was drawn. A separate source takes you to a London museum in 2022, where Imran Javed displayed an object connected to his own family's partition history. Keep these people and dates distinct when relating an experience to a later act of remembering.

Student task

What can Javed's 2022 display tell us about the place of partition in Britain's public memory? Use his object and one earlier account to develop an explanation, keeping the different people and dates distinct. Judge what his later choice to remember adds to an account of independence told only through borders, and how widely your interpretation can apply.

Interpret family memory · Your interpretation of a remembered past

One possible response

Iqbal's aunt's memory makes losing a home visible in a way a border cannot. It concerns displacement before the final 1947 boundary, so it cannot establish that this boundary caused the move. Javed's separate 2022 display gives a later example of remembering loss: his bracelet names his own family's lost Punjabi village. Exhibiting it in a London museum brings a private family connection into Britain's public account of South Asian heritage. Partition helps explain what the object remembers; Javed's decision explains why that memory becomes publicly visible here. This supports a claim about one act of remembrance, not everyone's identity or visitors' reactions.

Notes for the conversation

Students use one earlier account and Javed's separate 2022 display. Either Singh's concern about representation or the aunt's memory of displacement can enrich a borders-only narrative; both concern events before the final 1947 boundary. Javed's bracelet remembers his own family's lost Punjabi home. It is neither the aunt's object nor evidence that Singh's concern describes Javed's family. The documented bridge is a person choosing to bring family history into a London museum's public account of South Asian heritage. It supports an interpretation of this act of remembrance, not an inferred citizenship, a universal British Asian identity, or a claim that partition explains all South Asian migration to Britain. Family transmission and curatorial choice matter alongside the event being remembered. The source cannot tell us how every visitor interprets the display.

Evidence to draw on

- [The National Archives · Partition of British India](https://www.nationalarchives.gov.uk/education/teaching-resources/partition-of-british-india/)
<https://www.nationalarchives.gov.uk/education/teaching-resources/partition-of-british-india/>
- [British Museum · Imran Javed, A Confluence of Stories, 24 October 2022](https://www.britishmuseum.org/blog/confluence-stories)
<https://www.britishmuseum.org/blog/confluence-stories>
- [The National Archives · Indian independence, part one](https://www.nationalarchives.gov.uk/education/teaching-resources/indian-independence-part-one/)
<https://www.nationalarchives.gov.uk/education/teaching-resources/indian-independence-part-one/>

Other possible interpretations

- Using the aunt's account, a student can connect the human significance of losing home to Javed's distinct act of preserving his family's lost village through an object. The link is thematic and commemorative, not a shared biography.
- Using Singh's concern, a student can contrast uncertainty over political representation with the later ability of a curator to make one family's experience visible. That does not establish a direct causal path from the letter to the display.

Misconceptions to discuss

- The final 1947 border caused the displacement remembered before it was drawn.
- Javed's family and Iqbal's aunt are the same family.
- One object represents every South Asian person in Britain or proves visitors share one identity.

Use in discussion

- How does a private family object change when it enters a public museum?
- Why can neither the family object nor the earlier accounts represent everyone affected by partition?

5. Who gets to belong?

6 minutes · flexible planning guide

The student scenario

Empire Windrush was the name of a ship that brought passengers from the Caribbean and elsewhere to Britain in June 1948. At the time, Jamaica and several other Caribbean islands were British colonies, and their people were British subjects: they had a legal relationship with Britain through its empire. The name Windrush has also come to describe a wider generation of people who moved from the Caribbean to Britain after the Second World War.

Decades later, the Windrush scandal revealed that lawful residents had been wrongly treated as having no right to be in Britain. You will read Ena Sullivan's earlier record and a separate 2020 review with its 2022 follow-up, including another person's words about England and the policy decisions behind wrongful exclusion. A third source describes the National Windrush Monument unveiled in 2022. Consider how a legal relationship, institutional treatment, personal attachment and public recognition can differ. An act of commemoration does not itself show that earlier injustices have been resolved.

Student task

How far does the imperial relationship explain the tension between "my beloved England", the treatment described by the review and the public recognition offered by the 2022 monument? Analyse the witness's words, then assess what later policy choices and acts of remembrance add to your explanation of belonging.

Analyse and weigh explanations · Your argument about belonging

Map reference: jamaica, 1948.

One possible response

"My" asserts attachment to England and "beloved" makes the witness's criticism sound like hurt or betrayal. Imperial subjecthood helps explain an existing Caribbean relationship with Britain, rather than an arrival from an unrelated place. Yet later documentary requirements and administrative failures help explain how lawful residents were excluded; that outcome was not inevitable because of empire. The 2022 monument offers a different public recognition of this history, shaped partly by Basil Watson and public consultation. It can affirm a place for Caribbean migration in Britain's public memory without proving that unfair treatment has ended. Empire is therefore essential context for this tension, but later choices help explain both exclusion and commemoration. The witness is not Ena Sullivan, and neither source represents every migrant.

Notes for the conversation

Read "my beloved England" as a particular person's expression of attachment, then weigh its tension with institutional treatment and public recognition. A reading of hurt, betrayal or an assertion of belonging should connect words to the review's documented failures. Colonial subjecthood explains an established relationship with Britain; it does not make later documentary requirements and administrative failures inevitable. Those later choices help explain the mechanism of exclusion more immediately. The 2022 monument supplies a distinct commemorative intervention: Basil Watson, the committee, consultation and government support shaped what the public sees. It cannot establish that injustice was resolved or that all visitors feel welcome. Ena Sullivan's 1968 record and the review's unnamed witness are separate people; do not infer Ena's emotions or involvement in the scandal. Contributions to society are part of the history, not a condition people must meet to deserve belonging.

Evidence to draw on

- [The National Archives · Ena Clare Sullivan nationality registration, 3 December 1968 \(HO 334/1406/110478\), PDF pp. 19-21](https://cdn.nationalarchives.gov.uk/documents/education/empire-windrush-caribbean-migration.pdf#page=19)
<https://cdn.nationalarchives.gov.uk/documents/education/empire-windrush-caribbean-migration.pdf#page=19>
- [Wendy Williams · Windrush Lessons Learned Review \(2020\)](https://www.gov.uk/government/publications/windrush-lessons-learned-review)
<https://www.gov.uk/government/publications/windrush-lessons-learned-review>
- [Wendy Williams · Windrush review progress update, 31 March 2022](https://www.gov.uk/government/publications/windrush-lessons-learned-review-progress-update/windrush-lessons-learned-review-progress-update-accessible)
<https://www.gov.uk/government/publications/windrush-lessons-learned-review-progress-update/windrush-lessons-learned-review-progress-update-accessible>
- [UK Government · National Windrush Monument unveiled, 22 June 2022](https://www.gov.uk/government/news/national-windrush-monument-unveiled-at-london-waterloo-station)
<https://www.gov.uk/government/news/national-windrush-monument-unveiled-at-london-waterloo-station>
- [The National Archives · Nationality and the Immigration Act 1971](https://www.nationalarchives.gov.uk/education/resources/commonwealth-migration-since-1945/changes-to-british-nationality-act-with-immigration-act-1971/)
<https://www.nationalarchives.gov.uk/education/resources/commonwealth-migration-since-1945/changes-to-british-nationality-act-with-immigration-act-1971/>
- [Independent research · The Historical Roots of the Windrush Scandal](https://www.gov.uk/government/publications/the-historical-roots-of-the-windrush-scandal/the-historical-roots-of-the-windrush-scandal-independent-research-report-accessible)
<https://www.gov.uk/government/publications/the-historical-roots-of-the-windrush-scandal/the-historical-roots-of-the-windrush-scandal-independent-research-report-accessible>

Other possible interpretations

- A student may judge the imperial relationship crucial to understanding the tension, while giving later documentary rules and institutional failures greater explanatory force for the specific harm.
- A student may read the monument as a meaningful public assertion of belonging shaped by migrants and descendants, while arguing that recognition alone does not establish equal treatment. Different judgements about its significance can be supported.

Misconceptions to discuss

- The unnamed witness in the review is Ena Sullivan.
- Historical subjecthood, lawful residence and citizenship mean exactly the same thing.
- A public monument establishes that everyone now feels included or that discrimination has ended.

Use in discussion

- How do migrants and their descendants participate in choosing what Britain remembers?
- Why does evidence of public recognition differ from evidence of how welcome a person feels?

6. When does an empire end?

7 minutes · flexible planning guide

The student scenario

Kenya, in East Africa, was under British colonial rule. In the 1950s, the Mau Mau movement fought against that rule. The colonial government declared an emergency and detained many people, meaning it held them in camps or prisons, often without a trial. People suffered torture and other ill-treatment at the hands of the colonial authorities. Kenya became independent in 1963, but some survivors later brought claims against the British government over their treatment.

In 2013, Foreign Secretary William Hague announced a settlement of survivors' claims in Parliament. His statement expressed regret while denying liability, meaning legal responsibility. Ten years later, Charles III spoke in Kenya about colonial harm, the countries' relationship and British Kenyans. These are two dated official accounts. Examine how each presents Britain, while distinguishing the government's and monarch's positions from survivors' responses or the identities of people in Britain.

Student task

Does Charles's 2023 speech strengthen or complicate the recognition offered by Hague in 2013? Use the wording of Hague's statement and the King's account to assess how these institutions present Britain's imperial past and its relationship with Kenya. Explain what your judgement can-and cannot-show about ideas of Britain today.

Evaluate public recognition · Your judgement on Britain's public image

Map reference: kenya, 1963.

One possible response

Charles's 2023 account strengthens public recognition by naming colonial violence and connecting the past to a relationship with Kenya and British Kenyans. Hague's 2013 "sincerely regrets" already acknowledged abuse, backed by a settlement and memorial support, while "We continue to deny liability" limited legal responsibility. The King's later emphasis on partnership does not remove that qualification. I therefore find stronger public recognition without evidence of a fuller legal settlement. Colonial harm and survivors' claims explain why British institutions still address this past after independence. The two sources reveal official ways of presenting Britain, but cannot show whether survivors accepted them or how all British people identify.

Notes for the conversation

The task compares two dated official positions: Hague's 2013 statement and Charles's 2023 speech. Students should weigh whether the later account strengthens or complicates recognition. Hague expressed regret and announced a £19.9 million settlement, including legal costs, for 5,228 claimants and support for a Nairobi memorial, while denying liability. Charles condemned colonial violence, expressed sorrow and regret, and presented Kenya and Britain as partners; references to British Kenyans also locate the relationship within life in Britain. These are not interchangeable legal acts. The speech does not expand the settlement or prove survivors accepted the response. Historical harm and survivors' pursuit of redress help explain why the institutions address this past; their specific wording and choices shape the image of Britain presented. Students must keep a claim about official public memory distinct from one about every British resident's identity.

Evidence to draw on

- UK Government · Statement on settlement of Mau Mau claims, 6 June 2013
<https://www.gov.uk/government/news/statement-to-parliament-on-settlement-of-mau-mau-claims>
- Royal Household · Charles III at the state banquet in Kenya, 31 October 2023
<https://www.royal.uk/news-and-activity/2023-10-31/a-speech-by-his-majesty-the-king-at-the-state-banquet-kenya>
- Sino-British Joint Declaration · treaty text, 1984
<https://www.cmab.gov.hk/en/issues/jd2.htm>

Other possible interpretations

- A student may judge Charles's account to strengthen recognition through a fuller public acknowledgment and a forward-looking partnership, while noting that it does not alter Hague's legal qualification.
- A student may judge the language of partnership to complicate recognition by moving attention towards the future, while acknowledging that naming colonial harm remains meaningful. Survivors' perspectives would help assess adequacy.

Misconceptions to discuss

- The 2023 speech created a new settlement or accepted every legal claim.
- Regret, apology, liability and redress are interchangeable.
- The government or monarch speaks for all survivors, British Kenyans or British residents.

Use in discussion

- What would evidence from survivors or British Kenyans add to these official accounts?
- Does a later statement establish a changed relationship, or a claim about one?

The final comment

The past inside the present

20 minutes · flexible planning guide

The student scenario

Your school magazine is preparing an issue about British identities: how people describe themselves, where they feel they belong, and how Britain is publicly represented. The census evidence below shows that identities can overlap. It records people's chosen labels in England and Wales, not why they chose them. Your cases concern particular people, disputes or institutions; they cannot stand for everyone.

A historical fact alone does not explain an identity today. Connect it to a dated later experience or act of remembrance and explain why that link matters. "How far" asks what imperial history explains well, what it cannot explain, and why. Compare the two cases before reaching an overall judgement. Explain how a source limitation or another influence supported by evidence affects what you conclude. A comment presents and supports your view for readers who may know little about the history.

Student task

Write a comment for your school magazine answering: “How far does Britain’s imperial past help explain British identities today?” Choose two cases from your journey and explain how each helps you understand belonging, public memory or ideas about Britain today. Use historical and contemporary evidence for each case. Compare what imperial history explains across the two, then explain how a relevant limit or another influence supported by evidence changes your overall judgement.

Comment · Your school-magazine comment

- Before drafting, choose the historical evidence, the contemporary evidence and the connection you can explain for each case. Decide what those connections together justify-and what they leave unexplained.
- Name the source or person and date the contemporary evidence so readers can follow your thinking. The census can help you limit a claim about British identities; it does not show what caused them.

One possible synthesis

The end of colonial rule did not remove empire from Britain’s public stories or people’s sense of belonging. But different kinds of evidence support different explanations. In the Jamaica case, resistance, apprenticeship and compensation to owners complicate an account of Britain simply giving freedom. M Shed’s 2024 display of the toppled Colston statue, including protest material and contrasting perspectives, documents a modern British institution making disagreement over slavery visible. These are distinct episodes, but the history helps explain why honouring a slave trader can challenge a generous national self-image. It does not dictate the museum’s choices or visitors’ reactions.

Windrush provides a more direct connection to a person’s expressed belonging. Colonial subjecthood connected the Caribbean to Britain; the 2020 review records an affected person’s attachment to “my beloved England” alongside institutional harm. Later documentary rules and failures help explain that harm more immediately, while the 2022 monument shows a deliberate act of recognition. Empire supplies an important relationship, but later decisions shape its consequences.

The museum case therefore illuminates contested public memory, while Windrush also shows an individual attachment and its tension with treatment. Neither measures all British identities. The 2021 census permits overlapping labels but does not explain their causes. I can defend empire’s importance to these specific relationships and disputes, rather than claim it is the leading cause of everyone’s identity. That narrower conclusion follows from what the sources establish, not from proof that empire mattered little elsewhere.

Notes for the conversation

Read the final response as an argument for a school magazine, not as two separate historical summaries. Each chosen case needs historical evidence, a dated modern action or experience, and an explanation of the connection. Compare the kinds and strength of explanation: a museum dispute may illuminate contested public memory, while a witness supplies evidence of a particular attachment. Ask what the two cases together justify and how a specific limit changes that judgement. A limited source does not prove that empire had a small influence; it may mean the broader causal claim cannot be established. The required census card records overlapping identity labels in England and Wales in 2021, not their causes, the whole UK or opinion in 2026. An alternative influence must be evidenced, rather than added as a list of possible factors. The sample illustrates one defensible position and is not a required conclusion.

Other possible judgements

- A stronger claim may argue that imperial history is indispensable for understanding the selected public disputes and relationships, while showing that later institutions and individuals choose how to respond to that inheritance. Indispensable context is not a complete cause of every outcome.
- A more limited claim may argue that the sources establish specific acts of remembrance more clearly than they explain personal self-identification across Britain. That shifts the conclusion towards public memory; it does not prove that empire is unimportant to identities beyond the sources.
- Company rule and partition offer a different pair: the council's response concerns public honour, while Javed makes a family connection public. Comparing institutional and personal acts of selection can qualify a broad account of national memory without inventing a shared British opinion.
- Monarchy and Kenya can support an argument about changing official accounts of Britain's place in the world. Distinguish the constitutional change documented in 1949 from claims about recognition or partnership in speeches; acceptance and lived consequences need other evidence.

Misconceptions to discuss

- Two historical facts automatically explain two identities today.
- A museum display or official speech measures everyone's beliefs, or a limited source proves empire had little influence.
- Census labels reveal how much empire, region or any other factor caused people's identities.
- The class must agree with the teacher or reach one shared conclusion about identity.

Use in discussion

- Do your two cases explain the same aspect of identity or public memory, or different ones? What does that change about your judgement?
- Does a limit reveal that empire explains less, or only that these sources cannot establish a broader claim?

Optional supportive feedback

- Invite students to explain, compare and revise their ideas. Discuss evidence and reasoning without turning the examples into a required answer.
- Offer one optional next step that helps a student develop their own idea, such as: 'What does the historical detail explain about the dated modern example, and what depends on later choices?' Give the student time to revise if they wish.
- A source can be named naturally in a sentence: 'Parliament's account explains ...' or 'The Williams review records ...'. The notebook is optional, and formal citation formatting is unnecessary for this classroom activity.
- For contextual explanation, use the labelled summary or a teacher-issued equivalent if a link is blocked. When making a claim about a speaker's language choices, use the original wording printed in the source card or an equivalent original excerpt; an editorial summary cannot establish the original speaker's language choices.
- For English-language support, discuss one useful revision in audience, organisation or vocabulary. For example, replace an unclear 'they' with the group intended, or try 'although' to make a contrast visible. Keep factual clarification separate from language support.

- Work remains editable. Saving and downloading preserve a learning record; they do not lock a response or automatically judge its quality. The teacher material is openly accessible so students may use it as another support if that suits the lesson.

Supporting evidence

- ONS · National identity, England and Wales: Census 2021
<https://www.ons.gov.uk/peoplepopulationandcommunity/culturalidentity/ethnicity/bulletins/nationalidentityenglandandwales/census2021>
 - Bristol Museums · M Shed's Colston statue display, 15 March 2024
<https://www.bristolmuseums.org.uk/blog/new-display-at-m-shed-the-toppling-of-the-colston-statue/>
 - UK Parliament · The West Indian colonies and emancipation
<https://www.parliament.uk/about/living-heritage/evolutionofparliament/legislative scrutiny/parliament-and-empire/parliament-and-the-american-colonies-before-1765/the-west-indian-colonies-and-emancipation/>
 - Wendy Williams · Windrush Lessons Learned Review (2020)
<https://www.gov.uk/government/publications/windrush-lessons-learned-review>
 - Wendy Williams · Windrush review progress update, 31 March 2022
<https://www.gov.uk/government/publications/windrush-lessons-learned-review-progress-update/windrush-lessons-learned-review-progress-update-accessible>
 - UK Government · National Windrush Monument unveiled, 22 June 2022
<https://www.gov.uk/government/news/national-windrush-monument-unveiled-at-london-waterloo-station>
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Bring the class back together

- Which station changed your explanation rather than just adding a fact? Identify the evidence responsible.
- Choose one event whose colour on the map barely changes but whose significance for people is enormous. What does that reveal about historical maps?
- Can abolition be a source of pride without erasing enslavement and resistance? What would an honest commemorative text include?
- When are the actions of a state useful evidence about national identity, and when would that inference be too broad?
- What additional evidence would help distinguish imperial inheritance from later choices? Make one researchable question rather than a general opinion.
- Did your source limit show that empire explains less, or that the wider claim remains unestablished? Explain how that distinction affected your final judgement.

Support without supplying the answer

- Offer this thinking sequence: historical relationship → dated modern evidence → connection to a particular person or public account → what the evidence leaves unresolved. Then ask how that limit changes the overall claim. Students can plan it orally or in their optional notes; no extra form is needed.
- Give a small glossary: revenue = income collected by a government; sovereignty = supreme political authority; emancipation = release from slavery; citizenship = legal membership; identity = a person's or group's sense of belonging.

- Let pairs discuss one source before each student writes an individual response. Give students time to express and revise their own ideas.
- For language support, allow a bilingual glossary and a plan in the student's strongest language, then produce the response in English. Recognise historical understanding while teaching the English needed to express it. Offer a specific phrase or explanation that helps the student communicate their intended meaning.

Extend the enquiry

- Compare an official statement with a survivor's account, a local museum interpretation or a historian's analysis. Explain what changes when the viewpoint changes.
- Trace one named institution, place or object in Britain back to an imperial connection. Establish the connection through evidence rather than assuming its name is sufficient.
- Investigate whether another influence better explains an aspect of identity: locate evidence about class, religion, domestic constitutional history or later international relationships, then compare explanations. A list of possible influences alone cannot establish their importance.
- Investigate a case missing from the route, such as Ireland, Australia or an African territory. Explain whether it strengthens or changes your initial argument.

Sources & further reading

Essential pre-reading

- [Wendy Williams · Windrush review progress update, 31 March 2022](https://www.gov.uk/government/publications/windrush-lessons-learned-review-progress-update/windrush-lessons-learned-review-progress-update-accessible)

<https://www.gov.uk/government/publications/windrush-lessons-learned-review-progress-update/windrush-lessons-learned-review-progress-update-accessible>

The Background section explains documentary requirements and missing records. Keep this 2022 explanation distinct from the 2020 witness quotation.

- [The National Archives · Partition of British India](https://www.nationalarchives.gov.uk/education/teaching-resources/partition-of-british-india/)

<https://www.nationalarchives.gov.uk/education/teaching-resources/partition-of-british-india/>

Read the introduction and source questions; useful for separating a border change from human experience.

- [UK Parliament · The West Indian colonies and emancipation](https://www.parliament.uk/about/living-heritage/evolutionofparliament/legislativescrutiny/parliament-and-empire/parliament-and-the-american-colonies-before-1765/the-west-indian-colonies-and-emancipation/)

<https://www.parliament.uk/about/living-heritage/evolutionofparliament/legislativescrutiny/parliament-and-empire/parliament-and-the-american-colonies-before-1765/the-west-indian-colonies-and-emancipation/>

Secure the 1807/1834/1838 distinction before discussing national memory.

- [Wendy Williams · Windrush Lessons Learned Review \(2020\)](https://www.gov.uk/government/publications/windrush-lessons-learned-review)

<https://www.gov.uk/government/publications/windrush-lessons-learned-review>

Read the review's summary and recommendations, not the full report for this lesson.

- [UK Government · Statement on settlement of Mau Mau claims, 6 June 2013](https://www.gov.uk/government/news/statement-to-parliament-on-settlement-of-mau-mau-claims)

<https://www.gov.uk/government/news/statement-to-parliament-on-settlement-of-mau-mau-claims>

Read the statement's acknowledgement and legal qualification together.

- [ONS · National identity, England and Wales: Census 2021](https://www.ons.gov.uk/peoplepopulationandcommunity/culturalidentity/ethnicity/bulletins/nationalidentityenglandandwales/census2021)

<https://www.ons.gov.uk/peoplepopulationandcommunity/culturalidentity/ethnicity/bulletins/nationalidentityenglandandwales/census2021>

This is now required student evidence. Read the scope caveats: overlapping labels do not establish causes or measure attitudes to empire.

Extend your reading

- [UCL · Centre for the Study of the Legacies of British Slavery](https://www.ucl.ac.uk/social-historical-sciences/history/research/research-projects-and-centres/centre-study-legacies-british-slavery-csibbs)

<https://www.ucl.ac.uk/social-historical-sciences/history/research/research-projects-and-centres/centre-study-legacies-british-slavery-csibbs>

Follow the research database to test a specific connection between slavery and institutions in Britain.

- [The National Archives · Indian independence, part one](https://www.nationalarchives.gov.uk/education/teaching-resources/indian-independence-part-one/)

<https://www.nationalarchives.gov.uk/education/teaching-resources/indian-independence-part-one/>

A larger primary-source collection for an extended enquiry into decolonisation.

- [Independent research · The Historical Roots of the Windrush Scandal](https://www.gov.uk/government/publications/the-historical-roots-of-the-windrush-scandal/the-historical-roots-of-the-windrush-scandal-independent-research-report-accessible)

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Longer context on nationality, migration policy and the historical roots of the scandal.

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Empire / Echoes · Teacher handout · A learning enquiry: read, discuss, write and revise.